

VOICE-OVER RECORDING SCRIPT

One voice. 36 lines, about 299 words, across three minutes. The sparseness is deliberate – the film's argument is carried by music and by a number on screen driven by real crowd telemetry. The long silences are written in, not gaps waiting to be filled.

The speaker is the antagonist: the author of the argument for turning celebration down to a safe level. He is narrating in retrospect, to someone he assumes agrees with him, and he believes he is the reasonable party.

SMUG, NOT JACKBOOTED. Warm, unhurried, faintly amused, completely certain. Never angry, never menacing, never camp. A senior public-health official who is pleased to explain something to you and has never been contradicted. The film only works if his case genuinely lands.

Record dry: 48kHz 24-bit mono WAV, no processing of any kind. One file per line, named by its number. Three reads of each – as written, warmer, drier – in the same file. Plus thirty seconds of clean room tone as its own file.

ACT I	THE CLOSED FILE	0:00–0:35	7 lines
ACT II	THE MOONSHOT	0:35–1:05	7 lines
ACT III	IT WORKS, AND HE ARRIVES	1:05–1:35	7 lines
ACT IV	THE SQUEEZE	1:35–2:24	9 lines
ACT V	THE ANSWER	2:24–3:00	6 lines

ACT I – THE CLOSED FILE 0:00–0:35

A1 0:01.5 It is quiet now. We made it quiet.

Opening the film. Almost pleasant, and he takes the credit in the second sentence – the audience knows who did this before they know what it is. Past tense from the first word: he is already on the other side of it.

B1 0:05.5 They play the moon landing all day. To prove it is over.

Over 1969 on a CRT nobody watches. She is reading the official meaning off an image, flatly, the way you would read a plaque. Sets up the last line of the film.

0:10.5–0:14.5 – silence –

The power notice. The panel reads itself; do not talk over it.

A2 0:14.9 We already did the big thing. So nobody needs much power.

The whole argument of the film, in eleven plain words. Flat – a statement of policy, not a defence. Everything he does later follows from this one sentence, so it has to be completely clear and completely calm.

B2 0:19.8 Nothing left to do, they say. We call it the Nothing.

The official phrase is on the screen behind her, word for word, as she says it. First half a quotation held at arm's length, second half plain speech. Do not weight "the Nothing"; it is just what people inside it call it.

ACT I – THE CLOSED FILE 0:00–0:35

A3 0:25.2 I wrote the rules.

He is on screen. Not boastful. A small, satisfied fact – and it tells the audience he is not a guard, he is the author.

B3 0:27.5 They took our money. Last week, our power.

Straight after he claims authorship, so his sentence causes hers. "Last week" is doing the work – this is not history, it is happening now and it is speeding up. No self-pity. Two facts in the order they arrived.

B4 0:31.3 But the moon still pulls the sea. For free.

The hook. Over an airliner crossing the moon while nobody looks up. "But" is load-bearing: it is the first push back in the film. She has turned a closed file into a free power source. An engineer spotting something on a balance sheet, not poetry. The flatter it is read, the bigger it gets.

ACT II – THE MOONSHOT 0:35–1:05

- B5** 0:36.3 We have no power. So we have no machines.
Over the lab going dark – his budget footnote, from the other end. Present tense, matter of fact. A problem to be solved, not a grievance.
- B6** 0:40.6 So we are building a machine out of people.
The pivot of the film, and the "so" makes it a consequence rather than an idea. Say it as though it were the obvious next step, because to her it is.
- B7** 0:44.8 Breathing. Light. Sound. Three hundred people moving as one.
A parts list. Technical, unhurried, quietly pleased with how neat it is. No mysticism whatsoever.
- B8** 0:49.0 Together they make a signal. And we know where to point it.
The ritual as engineering. Even and explanatory. Slightly withheld on the second half – the beams answer it four seconds later.
- B9** 0:54.3 The number has to stay above eighty. That is the whole plan.
The most load-bearing line in the film. It hands the audience the scoreboard, and it names the thing in the corner of the frame so they know what to watch. Read it as a spec, not a challenge – she is stating a target, not making a vow. Everything after this is suspense only because this line is clear, so give it air.

ACT II – THE MOONSHOT 0:35–1:05

A4 0:59.6 They still get together. I think that is sweet.

Genuinely warm. No irony on "sweet". He has just heard the entire plan and understood none of it.

B10 1:03.8 Something is answering.

Over the readout waking, on the SIGNAL STRENGTH card. Three words. The first hint that anybody is out there – reported as a result, not a revelation.

ACT III – IT WORKS, AND HE ARRIVES 1:05–1:35

A5 1:06.0 Look at them. Really – look.

An invitation. He thinks he is showing you evidence.

1:09.1–1:13.5 – silence –

Blood moon, then the transformation. Nothing over it.

B11 1:14.0 It is changing us first.

This is what explains the beasts. An observation about a side effect she had not expected and does not regret. Three words, and the picture has just shown you what she means.

B12 1:17.5 That is the cost. You do not stay the same shape.

Flat, almost a technical footnote. The most frightening line she has, and only if it is read with no drama at all.

A6 1:22.9 Ninety-six decibels. Over the limit.

Purely administrative, and it states the rule he is about to enforce. The coldest line in the film and it must be the dullest.

B13 1:26.0 Seventy-nine point nine. Hold it there.

The number on screen reads 79.9 as she says it, and it never gets higher before the attack. She is one tenth short and she does not know that is as close as they will come. Do not play the disappointment – she still thinks they will get there. The audience does the ache.

ACT III – IT WORKS, AND HE ARRIVES 1:05–1:35

B14 1:29.4 Someone at the door is measuring us.

The two halves of the film touch for the first time. Not alarm – she has noticed something and is reporting it while she works. The audience is far more worried than she is.

B15 1:33.3 Not a reflection. An answer.

Over the moon going blood-orange. The payoff of the plan. Four words, the second pair landing on the cut. Do not raise the voice; the picture is shouting.

ACT IV – THE SQUEEZE 1:35–2:24

- A7** 1:36.6 And no one could tell me what it was for.
He was told, and did not listen – the audience has known since 0:54. On screen at the peak. Faint irritation, quickly controlled. In a finished world nothing **can** be for anything, so to him the question is sincere.
- A8** 1:41.6 We were like you once. We burned bright too.
Warmest line in the film. He is holding up his own book, offering his own life as proof he understands.
- B16** 1:45.8 They are not stopping the party. Just the number.
Over the readout being forced down. The thriller line, and now it says exactly what the attack is – he is not banning anything, he is deleting the evidence. Cold and clear, and slightly too late.
- A9** 1:50.0 You are not having fun. Your own machine says so.
Said kindly, the way a doctor breaks bad news gently. Devastating precisely because it is not cruel. Opens on its card.
- A10** 1:54.6 They kept dancing in the dark. We did not plan for that.
The one place the mask slips. He treated them as people who use electricity; they are not, which is the entire point of the ritual – he has cut the power to a machine that does not run on power. First sentence an observation, second a man reaching for flat official language to cover a hole in his sums. Let the last sentence sit slightly apart.

ACT IV – THE SQUEEZE 1:35–2:24

B17 1:59.9 It is coming back. Do not stop.

The cruellest placement in the film. The number really is climbing – 52 and rising – and she is urging the room on about one second before the breaker kills it. Play it as work, not triumph: she is calling out a reading and giving an instruction. She has no idea.

A11 2:03.3 So we cut the power.

Over the aftermath of the breaker. Absolutely neutral, and it answers her line directly without either of them knowing. Plain words make it worse, not softer.

A12 2:09.3 It is not cruel. It is just math.

Over the screens dying. Calm and, to him, obviously true – and it is true, which is the confession.

B18 2:15.0 Zero. We think we killed it.

The screen reads 0.0. The bottom of the film, and the only line where she is not quite in control – audible as a slight flattening, nothing more. Note the tense: she still does not know.

2:19.4–2:24.4 – silence –

The aftermath. Five seconds, no voice, almost no score. Do not fill this.

ACT V — THE ANSWER 2:24–3:00

A13 2:24.8 There was nothing left. I checked.

The number crosses eighty for the first time in the entire film four tenths of a second before he says this. Total confidence. He is contradicted by the corner of his own frame.

B19 2:29.8 It did not die. It just does not need us now.

Over the moon with an eye. It is alive and it is on its own. Quiet — the first time she sounds like anything other than an engineer.

2:34.4–2:40.4 — silence —

The lunar room. The film answers with pictures.

B20 2:40.7 Over eighty. It is holding.

The screen reads 85.0. The target from 0:54, cleared — the line the whole film has been waiting for, and it should be read as plainly as the reading at 1:26. The audience supplies the elation.

B21 2:43.3 We woke something up. And it came back for us.

Over the moon dance, as the group joins. The bond — the actual moonshot. Not triumph. Closer to being met.

ACT V – THE ANSWER 2:24–3:00

A14 2:47.9 We will need to do something about the moon.

His last line, and he has learned nothing – the logic does not stop, it moves up a scale. It lands *inside* the card where the machine picks a side, so he files a note about the moon while the thing commits behind him. Read exactly like A2: a small administrative note to himself. No wink. Funnier and worse if he means it.

2:51.7–2:55.1 – silence –

The rest of the sign-on, and the van. The machine changing sides is a signature, not an argument; nobody narrates it.

B22 2:55.1 They said it was behind us. It is ahead of us.

The last line of the film, over the title, answering B1 word for word. Flat and certain. Not a rallying cry – a correction to the record.